

THE HOOK

A man builds a test. He writes down what he expects, in public, before he looks. Then he runs it and he loses.

Weeks later, fixing something unrelated, he finds a page his script never downloaded. That page belongs to the side that beat him.

Fixing it turns his failure into a success. Every step of fixing it is correct. Watch where this goes.

64 words · 28s at 135 wpm

THEN, OFF THE PAGE

- Say the title. Say what the channel is.
- "Nothing in this video needs you to know who Girard is."

WHAT THIS EPISODE HAS TO ANSWER

1. What was the Diodorus decision, and what exactly was decided?
2. Why can a chain of locally defensible steps end somewhere indefensible?
3. How does the sample relate to the pre-registration, and why is that new?

WHERE TO GO FOR DEPTH

- research S2E07 p.1 the story, July, the two bugs before it
- research S2E07 p.2 the five statements, and 13.95 -> 13.67
- research S2E07 p.3 the rule, and post-hoc exclusion criteria
- research S2E07 p.4 the length rule that was in a doc and not in the code
- source ~/Myths/CORRECTION-1.md the five statements, in his words
- context S2E03 p.2 what a timestamp proves, for the "invisible from inside" line
- deeper Assumed Knowledge Q13 one-tailed, Q35 ASV/KJV, not needed here

A GUY FIXES A BUG. THAT IS THE WHOLE STORY.

- 1

SAY

I want to tell you about somebody fixing a small mistake. No theory, no Bible, no philosophy. A guy fixed a bug in a computer script.
- 2

SAY

He is testing an idea about myths. To test it he needs a pile of old Greek texts on his computer.
- 3

SHOW

the two piles, and the numbers on them
- 4

SAY

He predicted the second pile would score higher than the first. He wrote that down before he looked.
- 5

SAY

He was wrong. 13.95 against 13.88. He lost by four hundredths and he published that he lost.
- 6

ASK

Now hold that. He has already lost, in public. Written down.
- 7

SAY

Weeks later he is fixing something completely different, and he notices a page of one text never got downloaded. The script missed a link.
- 8

LAND

And the missing page belongs to the pile that beat him.

MYTHOGRAPHY	13.95	he predicted LOWER
TRAGEDY	13.88	he predicted HIGHER
lost by	0.04	
already published	as a failure	

what was missing	one page of Diodorus
why	a script did not follow a link
is it real	yes, part of the text
did anyone hide it	no

"No theory yet. Just a guy and a bug."

"Say the number out loud. Nought point nought four. That is nothing. And nothing still loses."

Gear: So. Weeks later.

draw: two bars, 13.95 and 13.88, then circle the tiny gap

FIVE SENTENCES. REJECT ONE.

- 1

SAY

I am going to read five sentences. Every one is true. Every one is what a careful person would say.
- 2

SHOW

the five, one at a time, do not rush
- 3

ASK

Which one do you reject?
- 4

WAIT

actually stop. let them try it.
- 5

SAY

Let us go along the row and try rejecting each one out loud.
- 6

SHOW

the four rejections, and how stupid each sounds
- 7

THEY

"Obviously you fix the bug. That is just being careful."
- 8

SAY

Yes. That is exactly what makes this hard.
- 9

LAND

Four of the five cannot be rejected by anybody.

- 1

The page really is part of that text.
- 2

The fetcher really did have a bug, and the bug is now fixed.
- 3

Fixing bugs in your pipeline is what you are supposed to do.
- 4

The corrected corpus is more accurate than the one you scored.
- 5

Therefore rescore with the corrected corpus.

- reject 1

a page of Diodorus is not part of Diodorus
- reject 2

a bug you found and fixed was not a bug
- reject 3

pipelines should be left broken
- reject 4

the corpus missing a page is the more accurate one

"Say it in your head before I do."

"You already know which one has to go. You just cannot say why yet."

"Every one of these is what a careful person does."

draw: the row of five, cross out four

THE FAILED PREDICTION PASSES

- 1

SAY

So he does it. He follows all five. He fixes the bug and rescores.
- 2

SHOW

the before and after
- 3

SAY

13.95 becomes 13.67. The other number does not move.
- 4

ASK

What just happened to his prediction?
- 5

WAIT

let them see it themselves
- 6

SAY

It passed. The thing he published as a failure is now a success, and he did nothing wrong at any point.
- 7

SHOW

the quote, read it slowly
- 8

LAND

"None of it felt like cheating."

MYTHOGRAPHY	13.95	→	13.67
TRAGEDY	13.88	→	13.88
prediction	FAIL	→	PASS

from the correction file, written by the person it happened to:

"It would have been entirely defensible as a bug fix, and it is exactly the move pre-registration exists to make impossible."

"Read it again. Not: I was tempted and I resisted."

"Not: I noticed what I was about to do."

"It did not feel like anything. That is the whole problem."

NONE OF IT FELT LIKE CHEATING

draw: arrow 13.95 down to 13.67, then across the tragedy line

WHY BEING CAREFUL IS WHAT GETS YOU

- 1 **ASK** If you wanted to stop this happening to you, what would you rely on?
- 2 **THEY** "I would just be honest about it."
- 3 **NO** Nothing here was dishonest. Not one false sentence was written.
- 4 **THEY** "I would be careful."
- 5 **NO** The whole sequence IS being careful. Fixing the bug was the careful act.
- 6 **SHOW** the rest of the defences, and why each one is useless
- 7 **ASK** So what was he actually doing at the moment it happened?
- 8 **SAY** Maintenance. He was not looking at the prediction at all.
- 9 **LAND** **The habits that protect you everywhere else are what walk you in here.**

the defence why it fails here

honesty no false statement occurs anywhere

integrity nothing presented itself as a choice about it

care the whole sequence IS care

expertise the chain is only visible if you watch for it

what he was doing fixing a bug he had just found

what he was not doing looking at the prediction

"Watch which defence you reach for first. I reached for honesty."

"Every one of them is a virtue and every one of them is useless."

"If you are thinking you would have caught it, hold that. I will come back to it."

NONE OF IT FELT LIKE CHEATING

2 of 3

draw: the chain, link by link, no branch points

POINT AT THE DECISION. GO ON.

- 1

SAY

Think about Walter White. Just the early episodes, before anything big.
- 2

ASK

Point at the scene where he decides to become a criminal.
- 3

WAIT

genuinely wait. they will try.
- 4

THEY

"The pilot? When he cooks the first batch?"
- 5

NO

He is dying and broke and wants to leave money behind. That is a reasonable thing for a man in that spot.
- 6

SAY

Every single step is a sensible answer to the step before it. There is no scene. There is a chain.
- 7

ASK

So how does anybody in that story know where they are?
- 8

SAY

In the show, you know, because you are watching from outside and you can see it going somewhere.
- 9

LAND

In a research project nobody is watching from outside, because the destination is a number that came out slightly different.

no scene

in which he chooses to become a criminal

every step

a reasonable response to the step before

answer

there isn't one

the show

the audience can see where it goes

a research project

nobody can

the five statements

the same chain, one afternoon

"Point at it. Go on."

"In the show you get sixty hours and a soundtrack. Here you get one afternoon and a spreadsheet."

Gear: Now watch what he actually did.

draw: chain again, label where the afternoon sits

HE KEEPS THE BROKEN VERSION ON PURPOSE

- 1

SAY

Here is what he actually did, and it is strange. He fetched the missing page. It is on his disk right now.
- 2

SAY

And he refuses to use it.
- 3

ASK

Why would anybody keep the worse version?
- 4

THEY

"That is stupid. You have the better data right there."
- 5

SAY

He rejects statement 5. Only statement 5. Only for this round.
- 6

SAY

So he publishes a number computed on a corpus he knows is missing a page, while the fixed corpus sits on the same machine.
- 7

SAY

And the page becomes available again the moment a new prediction is written down first.
- 8

LAND

The instrument is kept less accurate than it could be, on purpose, and that is the right call.

the page was fetched it is on the disk

the page is excluded from the analysis

permanently from this round

available to a future round whose predictions are committed first

reject statement 5

only statement 5

only for this round

"Say how strange that is out loud. Do not smooth it."

"It is the right call and nothing about it feels right while you are doing it."

"You would have rescored. So would I. That is the point of the whole video."

NONE OF IT FELT LIKE CHEATING

draw: two disks, one used, one not

on disk, excluded · round 2 only

loop out › And out of this, a rule got written that had not existed before.

THE SAMPLE IS PART OF THE CLAIM

- 1

SAY

Everybody already knows one version of this rule.
- 2

SAY

You cannot change your hypothesis after you have seen the data. Everyone nods at that.
- 3

ASK

So why does almost nobody say the other half?
- 4

LAND

You cannot change your sample either.
- 5

SAY

Not the instrument. The sample. The texts themselves are part of what you promised.
- 6

SAY

And I will tell you why this one stayed with me all week.

everyone knows you cannot change your hypothesis after seeing the data

far fewer know you cannot change your sample either

not just the instrument the sample is part of the registration

"This is the one that has bothered me since I read it."

"He is not a fraud. He is the most careful person in this story."